Agile Team Charter: Pretoria Prime Recycling

1. Team Purpose & Vision

- **Team Mission:** Solve poor waste management and inconvenient recycling disposal for middle-to-upper-class homeowners in Silver Lakes, Pretoria, by offering a reliable, weekly door-to-door recyclable collection service.

- **Success Definition:**
    - Achieve at least 80% active interest and positive engagement from community interactions.
    - Secure paying households committing to the collection service.
    - Establish reliable weekly door-to-door pickups without missed collections.

- **Product / Service:** Pretoria Prime Recycling — a localized door-to-door recyclable collection service, customer onboarding workflow, and digital engagement platform (Figma prototype, Instagram, and WhatsApp Business).

2. Team Members & Roles

The four student founders share cross-functional ownership across operations, customer discovery, and platform design:

Name	Role	Key Responsibilities
Lebogang Andile Mahlangu	Product Owner (PO)	Owns the product backlog, defines user stories, leads customer discovery/validation, and ensures alignment with the Silver Lakes target market.
Nonhlanhla Hazel Mahlangu	Agile Lead / Scrum Master	Facilitates ceremonies, tracks sprint progress, clears operational blockers, and ensures adherence to team working agreements.

Name	Role	Key Responsibilities
Ntombozuko Palisa Mchophele	Operations & Logistics Specialist	Plans collection schedules, coordinates protective equipment/bins, and manages external recycling partner drops.
Siphokazi Malingatshoni	UI/UX & Systems Analyst	Maintains the Figma interactive prototype, tracks registration/survey metrics in Google Sheets, and assists with customer data flow.

3. Ways of Working

3.1 Agile Framework

- **Scrum** (running 1-week or 2-week deliverable sprints tailored to academic and pilot milestones)
- **Kanban** (using a shared board for continuous collection and validation tracking)

3.2 Ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency	Purpose
Daily Stand-up	3x weekly (Mon / Wed / Fri, 15 min)	Share progress, plan next tasks, and surface collection or design blockers early.
Sprint Planning	Beginning of each sprint (45 min)	Break down deliverable requirements into backlog tasks and allocate responsibilities.
Review / Demo	End of each sprint (30 min)	Inspect completed deliverables (e.g., MVP engagement metrics, Figma updates, flyer proofs).
Retrospective	Directly after Sprint Review (30 min)	Discuss what went well, what stalled, and agree on actionable process improvements.

4. Working Agreements

- We show up prepared and on time to all scheduled syncs.
- We respect designated timeboxes for all discussions and ceremonies.
- We give constructive, respectful, and actionable feedback.
- We raise blockers (e.g., student workload, logistics snags) immediately rather than waiting for deadlines.

- Tasks taken from the board must have clear acceptance criteria before execution begins.
- All project files, designs, and contact sheets must be stored in the shared team repository.

5. Communication

- **Primary Channels:** WhatsApp Group for rapid daily coordination and urgent alerts; Microsoft Teams / Google Drive for file storage, document collaboration, and meetings.
- **Response-Time Expectations:**
    - Urgent matters: Within 2 hours.
    - Routine queries: Within 12 hours during core working windows (08:00 – 18:00).
- **Remote / Hybrid Norms:** Cameras on for planning and retrospective meetings; maintain clear availability status during project work sessions.

6. Decision-Making

- **Consensus** (preferred for major scope adjustments and operational strategy)
- **Product Owner final decision** (for feature priority, scope cuts, and deliverable trade-offs)
- **Agile Lead decides after input** (for workflow, schedule adjustments, or unresolved deadlocks)

Escalation Path: If the team remains split 50/50 after a 15-minute timebox, the Product Owner makes the call on product scope, while the Agile Lead decides on process and timelines. If team conflict persists, escalate to the academic project supervisor/lecturer.

7. Definition of Done (DoD)

A deliverable or sprint backlog item is considered **Done** only when:

- All functional requirements described in the task card are fully implemented.

- Marketing assets or UI prototypes adhere to brand guidelines and pass peer review.
- Operational plans are verified against budget and resource feasibility (e.g., transport costs within the R1,500 – R3,250 window).
- Documentation, links (Figma), and tracking sheets are updated and accessible.
- Product Owner formally accepts and signs off on the item.

8. Core Values & Behaviours

- **Respect:** Value every team member's input, time, and academic commitments.
- **Transparency:** Keep sprint progress, field findings, and roadblocks visible on the board.
- **Accountability:** Own assigned tasks from start to finish; communicate delays ahead of time.
- **Trust:** Rely on teammates to execute their roles independently and support each other when overwhelmed.
- **Learning Mindset:** View feedback and pilot iteration data as opportunities to refine the business model.

9. Risks & Constraints

- **Known Risks:**
    - *Market & Behavioral:* Residents fail to separate waste or show low willingness to pay.
    - *Financial:* Recycling drop-off revenue fluctuations and insufficient subscription volume to offset collection expenses.
    - *Operational:* Vehicle/transport unreliability or missed weekly pickup windows damaging community trust.
- **Dependencies:** Timely access to transport (bakkie rental/fuel allowance), municipal drop-off sites/recycling buy-back centers, and active WhatsApp community moderators in Silver Lakes.
- **Constraints:**

- Limited startup budget (R1,500 – R3,250).
- Geographic focus limited to the Silver Lakes pilot zone.
- Team members balancing academic course loads alongside startup operations.

10. Review & Improvement

- **Charter Review Frequency:** Retrospective (end of each deliverable cycle / sprint)
- **Last Updated:** October 2026

11. Team Commitment

Name	Role	Signature / Agreement
Lebogang Andile Mahlangu	Product Owner	*Agreed & Signed*
Nonhlanhla Hazel Mahlangu	Agile Lead	*Agreed & Signed*
Ntombozuko Palisa Mchophele	Operations Specialists	*Agreed & Signed*
Siphokazi Malingatshoni	Systems / UX Analyst	*Agreed & Signed*